Past Tense

	First person	Second person	Third person
Affirmative			
***Singular**	I **sang** yesterday.	You **sang** yesterday.	She/He/It **sang** last week.
***Plural**	We **sang** yesterday.	You **sang** yesterday.	
Negative	I **didn't sing** yesterday.	You **didn't sing** yesterday.	She/He/It **didn't sing** last week.
Interrogative	**Did/ Didn't** I **sing** yesterday?	**Did/ Didn't** you **sing** yesterday?	**Did/ Didn't** she/he/it **sing** last week?

Forms and uses of the Simple Past Tense

Uses

- To indicate an action that was completed in the past. Generally the adverbials of past time are used; sometimes without adverbials of time for an activity done in the past
- To express a habitual or regular action only in the past; It can also be expressed by using 'used to'
- In conditional clauses
- In the indirect form of speech
- To express two actions, where the first action leads instantly to the second action

e.g. When the meeting ended, the staff members came out.

Forms and Uses of Past Continuous Tense

	First person	Second person	Third person
Affirmative			
***Singular**	I **was singing.** yesterday by this time.	You **were singing** when I was playing.	She/He/It **was singing** yesterday by this time.
***Plural**	We **were singing** yesterday by this time.	You **were singing** when I was playing.	They **were singing** when I was playing.
Negative	I **wasn't singing**	You **weren't singing**	She/He/It **wasn't singing**

Uses

- To express a state or an action that was continuing at a certain point of time in the past. It had begun before that point and was probably continuing after it. We use adverbials of time.

e.g. We were decorating the house for the birthday party in the morning.

- To express an action that was in progress in the past

10th English_Unit_3.indd 78 28-11-2022 18:20:33